

same time—hold down [Ctrl] and select the layers you want to link, and click on the chain-link icon  at the bottom

- Set layer opacity
- Lock properties of a layer such as position and transparency
- Create layer masks, adjustment layers and layer effects

If any of this confuses you, pay no heed to it for now—you will become more than familiar with these features as we go along.

At the top right corner of the Layers palette, you will find a small arrow icon—click on it to bring up the Layers Palette Menu, which gives you a list of commands you'll often need when working with layers. By default, Photoshop shows you a little thumbnail for each layer in the Layers palette, but if you are working at a lower resolution such as 1024 x 768, you can turn off these thumbnails to save some screen space. This won't seem like much at first, but it's going to make a huge difference if you have fifteen or so layers in the image. To choose the size of the layer thumbnails, bring up the Layer Palette menu and select Palette Options. Choose the size of the layer thumbnail from here.

1.3.3 The Channels Palette

The colours we see all around us are a mixture of the three primary colours—Red, Green and Blue (RGB). In a digital image, each pixel is defined by the intensity of each of these colours, in effect, making it the sum of the Red,



The Channels Palette

Green and Blue *channels*. The Channels palette shows you the intensity of the primary colours as greyscale images. For example, white areas in the Red channel indicate a 100% intensity of Red in the area, while black areas indicate the complete absence of any Red.